

The Cowardly Horse

Once upon a time, a fine looking horse lived in a forest. Although he was tall and strong, the horse was a big **coward**. He was **terrified** when he heard the **roar** of a hungry tiger – even the sudden **chirping** of **crickets** made him **squirm** with fear.

One day he met a farmer who listened to his **tale** of **woe** with a **great deal of sympathy**.

“Why don’t you come home with me?” asked the farmer. “I have a big **barn** with a strong door. You’ll be safe inside.”

The horse decided that he had nothing to lose and followed his new-found friend to his farm. Soon they were standing in front of a large wooden barn. The farmer opened the door and **ushered** the horse in with a great deal of ceremony. He **tethered** the horse to a wooden post and gave him grain and **hay** to eat. He then locked the door of the barn and **went off** to his own **modest dwelling**.

The horse felt safe and secure and ate **contentedly munching** on the hay. “I wouldn’t mind at all if I had to spend the rest of my life here,” he **muttered** to himself, not realizing how **prophetic** those words were to be.

At the crack of dawn the barn door opened and the farmer **marched in**. He roughly **roused** the sleeping horse and slipped a **bridle** on his head. He then led his unwilling guest outside.

“Where are you taking me?” demanded the horse.

“I can’t feed **idle** mouths,” was the **laconic** reply.

The farmer took the horse to his field and **hitched** him to his **plough**. Then snatching a **whip** he made the horse draw long **furrows** in the field.

The farmer forced the horse to plough his fields every day and each time he thought of the safe barn he felt a silent **resentment**. “I should have **jumped from the frying pan into the fire**! How I wish I’d remained in the forest and **taken my chances** with the tigers!”

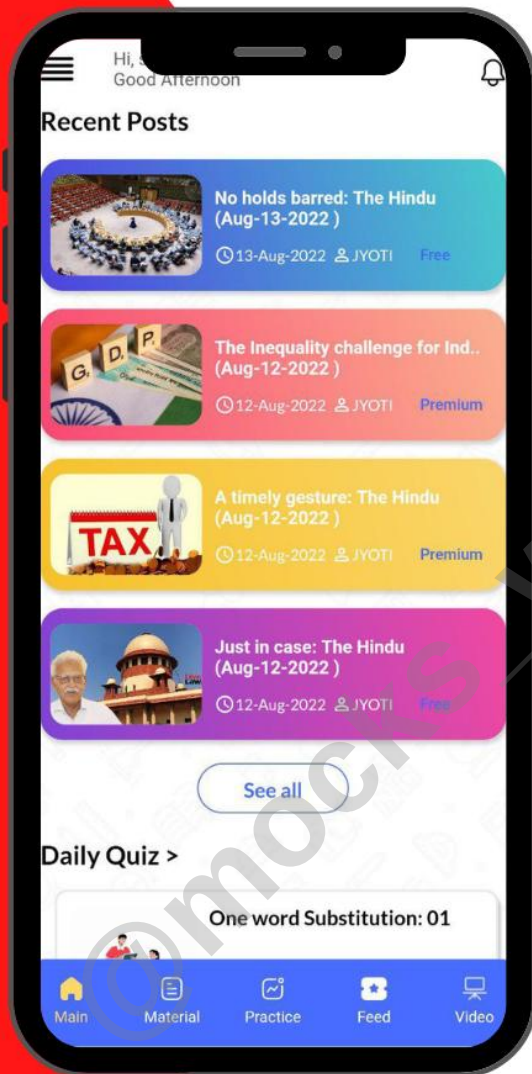
But words of **regret** were useless, for he was well and truly trapped in a web of his own making.



Vocabulary

1. **Cowardly** (adverb) – timidly, fearfully, spinelessly, cravenly, faintheartedly
कायरता से
2. **Coward** (adjective) – fearful, timid, spineless, fainthearted, gutless कायर
3. **Terrify** (verb) – frighten, scare, alarm, horrify, petrify डराना
4. **Roar** (noun) – bellow, growl, howl, boom, shout गरज
5. **Chirping** (noun) – tweeting, trilling, warbling, singing, peeping चहचहाहट
6. **Cricket** (noun) – grasshopper-like insect, chirper झींगुर
7. **Squirm** (verb) – wriggle, twist, fidget, writhe, shuffle कसमसाना
8. **Tale** (noun) – story, narrative, yarn, account, chronicle कहानी
9. **Woe** (noun) – misery, sorrow, distress, grief, trouble दुःख
10. **A great deal of** (phrase) – much, plenty of, a lot of, considerable amount of बहुत सारा
11. **Sympathy** (noun) – compassion, pity, understanding, concern, kindness सहानुभूति
12. **Barn** (noun) – stable, cowshed, shelter, shed, outbuilding पशुशाला
13. **Usher (in)** (verb) – lead, guide, escort, conduct, show in अंदर ले जाना
14. **Tether** (verb) – tie, fasten, hitch, secure, bind बांधना
15. **Hay** (noun) – dried grass, fodder, straw, forage, silage घास
16. **Go off** (phrasal verb) – leave, depart, exit, withdraw, head out चले जाना
17. **Modest** (adjective) – simple, humble, unpretentious, plain, moderate सादा
18. **Dwelling** (noun) – home, house, residence, abode, habitation निवास
19. **Contentedly** (adverb) – happily, satisfiedly, peacefully, gladly, joyfully संतोषपूर्वक
20. **Munch** (verb) – chew, crunch, bite, gnaw, nibble चबाना
21. **Mutter** (verb) – murmur, whisper, mumble, grumble, complain बड़बड़ाना
22. **Prophetic** (adjective) – predictive, foretelling, visionary, prescient, foreshadowing भविष्यवाणी संबंधी
23. **At the crack of dawn** (phrase) – at daybreak, at first light, early in the morning सुबह-सुबह

24. **March (in)** (verb) – stride, stomp, parade, step in, walk firmly अंदर आना (तेज़ कदमों से)
25. **Rouse** (verb) – awaken, stir, arouse, provoke, excite जगाना
26. **Bridle** (noun) – headgear, harness, reins, tack लगाम
27. **Idle** (adjective) – lazy, inactive, sluggish, indolent, unoccupied आलसी
28. **Laconic** (adjective) – brief, terse, concise, pithy, succinct संक्षिप्त
29. **Hitch** (verb) – attach, fasten, hook, tie, yoke जोड़ना
30. **Plough** (noun) – cultivator, tiller, harrow, farming implement हल
31. **Whip** (noun) – lash, scourge, rod, strap, switch कोड़ा
32. **Furrow** (noun) – groove, trench, rut, channel, crease नाली
33. **Resentment** (noun) – bitterness, anger, displeasure, indignation, grudge आक्रोश
34. **Jump from the frying pan into the fire** (phrase) – go from bad to worse, worsen situation, make a bad choice आसमान से गिरकर खजूर में अटकना
35. **Take one's chance** (phrase) – risk it, try, attempt, venture, gamble जोखिम लेना
36. **Regret** (noun) – remorse, guilt, repentance, sorrow, contrition पछतावा



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